Mathew Thornton

AI & automation engineer who also runs the infrastructure

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Systems administrator of 6+ years who became a builder. Ran production IT for a SaaS company, then founded an AI automation company (live with 5 clients) and shipped local-first AI apps, a homelab platform run entirely as code, and multi-agent tooling. Strongest where AI meets operations: agents that act on real systems, run safely, and are observable.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Engineer, Assisted Growth Partner (AGP) — Feb 2026 - Present

- Designed, built and operate an AI voice-receptionist and automation platform for local service businesses, live with 5 clients (inbound and outbound calling on Vapi, GoHighLevel CRM and calendar sync).
- Built about 140 n8n workflows: multi-tenant onboarding and provisioning, an outbound campaign dispatcher with a queue, social-media autopilot, Meta ad generation, and cost/billing dashboards.
- Shipped a 'Lead-Leak Audit' product: intake, an enrichment and scoring engine, AI-generated tailored reports, and AI-generated preview websites for prospects (Next.js, Postgres, Claude).
- Run the production stack on a VPS: Docker, Traefik, Postgres, Redis, queue-mode n8n with workers, and Uptime Kuma.

System Administrator, Cority (formerly Enviance), Carlsbad, CA — 2019 - Oct 2025

- Ran IT for a mid-sized SaaS company across two offices, a data center and remote staff.
- Built, patched, upgraded and troubleshot physical and virtual Windows and Linux servers (VMware ESXi, iDRAC, blades and rack-mount).
- Owned backups (tape, offsite and cloud), licensing and vendor coordination, and access management in Active Directory and Azure AD.
- Managed Cisco Meraki and Catalyst networking, firewalls and VPN (full and split tunnel), and monitoring with PRTG; reported regularly to the CTO.

Desktop Support Technician, Enviance, Carlsbad, CA — 2017 - 2019

- Handled internal support by phone, email and in person; imaged and deployed workstations; onboarded new hires in Active Directory.

Sales & retail management, GreatCall · Living Spaces · Fry's Electronics — 2010 - 2017

- High-volume customer-facing sales and team supervision. That's where the habit of explaining technical things plainly comes from.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Kapti, Desktop app · Rust + Tauri

- A meeting assistant that never phones home: it records, transcribes and writes notes entirely on your own PC. Captures the mic and system audio as separate tracks, or a single app's audio, and transcribes on-device with Whisper or Parakeet.

`Rust · Tauri 2 · Next.js / TypeScript · whisper.cpp · Parakeet · llama.cpp · SQLite FTS5`

Homelab platform, Infrastructure as code

- 36 self-hosted services rebuilt from scratch as code, with deploys gated by policy checks. 36 Compose stacks on one host: edge and SSO, monitoring and alerting, restic backups, Gitea, media, photos (Immich), local LLMs (Ollama, Open WebUI, ComfyUI), n8n, Vaultwarden, and my own apps (Forge, Tally).

`Docker Compose · Traefik · Authentik SSO · Prometheus + alerting · Gitea · Ollama · Cloudflare Tunnel · Bash`

AGP automation platform, AI voice + automation · business

- An AI receptionist and automation stack for local businesses, built and run as a solo founder, live with 5 clients. The AI receptionist answers and books calls; each call is logged with a transcript, a heat score, an AI recommendation and the close outcome.

`n8n (queue mode) · Vapi voice AI · GoHighLevel · Postgres · Next.js · Claude API · Docker + Traefik`

Tally, Web app · open source

source

- Self-hosted personal finance built around one question: does the money last until the next money? Connects to real banks through Plaid and is read-only by design: it can see accounts but can never move money.

`Python · FastAPI · Postgres · React / Vite · Plaid · Ollama`

Forge, Mobile + server

- A local-first strength-training app with a self-hosted AI coach. The phone stores everything locally and syncs to a self-hosted server; the coach reviews workouts and answers questions with each person's own context.

`React Native / Expo · SQLite · Fastify / TypeScript · Postgres · Ollama + vision model · Python (form-check worker)`

SKILLS

AI & agents: Claude API and Claude Code (agents, tools, hooks, plugins), Multi-agent design, Local inference: Ollama, llama.cpp, Whisper/Parakeet, Retrieval: SQLite FTS5, pgvector, Voice AI (Vapi), Prompt and eval design

Automation: n8n (queue mode, sub-workflows, error handling), Webhooks and API integration, CRM automation (GoHighLevel), Telegram and Slack bots

Platform & DevOps: Docker and Compose, Traefik, Linux administration, GitHub Actions CI, Prometheus and alerting, Authentik SSO, Cloudflare Tunnel, Backup and restore design, Policy-as-code deploy gates

Systems & networking: Windows Server, Active Directory and Azure AD, VMware ESXi / iDRAC, Cisco Meraki and Catalyst, Firewalls and VPN, PowerShell

Software: TypeScript / Node, Next.js / React, React Native / Expo, Python / FastAPI, Rust / Tauri, Postgres / SQLite